

Title: Introduction and Guide to CPR [Manual]

Excerpt: Over half a million cardiac arrests occur every year in the United States alone, so it is important to know what to do when you witness one. CPR can increase survival rates by up to three times, and it's not just for first responders to do. Bystanders can take action once they learn the essentials of CPR.

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Title & Overview:

CPR stands for cardiopulmonary resuscitation, and it is used when the heart stops beating completely or is not beating enough to deliver blood to the brain and other organs. CPR's main role is to continue to pump blood to the brain and vital organs, lowering the risk for brain damage until emergency responders arrive.

Before Starting:

Before performing CPR, check the area to make sure that you are safe. Do not put yourself at risk! Check for normal breathing. If they aren't breathing or only gasping, start CPR immediately. Also, call 9-1-1 or ask another person to do so and get access to an AED.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. Check the scene to ensure it is safe to perform CPR; you do not want to put your own life at risk.
2. If a person looks to be unresponsive, check to see if they are still breathing. Check responsiveness explicitly by tapping their shoulders and shouting, then checking for any response.
3. If the person does not appear to be able to respond, call 9-1-1 immediately and prepare actions for CPR.
4. Call someone directly to get an AED and first aid kit if available.

5. Kneel beside the victim and place them on a firm, flat surface to ensure maximum impact. Soft surfaces, like a bed or sofa, can reduce the effectiveness of CPR.
6. The following guidelines are from the American Red Cross:
 - a. *Rate*: 100 to 120 chest compressions per minute, 30 at a time.
 - b. *Hands*: two hands on the chest.
 - c. *Body*: lock your elbows and put your shoulder directly over your hands.
 - d. *Compression*: You want to go at least 2 inches deep into their chest.
 - e. Allow the chest to recover to its normal position after every compression.
7. Prepare to give 2 breaths:
 - a. Tilt the person's head back until their head is slightly beyond its normal position to open their airway.
 - b. Pinch their nose shut, inhale, and exhale while completely sealing your mouth over theirs
 - c. Give each breath over 1 second and check to see if it makes the person's chest rise. Give time for the air to exit before you repeat.
 - d. *If the 1st breath doesn't cause the chest to rise, readjust their head position and ensure you are sealing your mouth over them properly. If the 2nd breath doesn't make the chest rise, something might be blocking their airway
8. Continue to give 30 chest compressions and 2 breaths. Use an AED as soon as you get one. Minimize interruptions to chest compressions for less than 10 seconds. Turn it on and follow the given prompts that it gives.

Tips & Warnings:

Most critically, minimize CPR interruptions as much as possible. Each second of interruption is less oxygen delivered to the brain, increasing the risk of brain damage before help arrives. If you are untrained in CPR, you do not have to provide rescue breaths; simply performing hands-only CPR is sufficient. You can keep track of the correct beat by following the beat of songs like "Stayin' Alive."

Push hard and fast: compressions should be deep and consistent to make sure that the heart is beating and moving blood around the body consistently. It is also better not to bend your elbows when giving compressions; use your body weight!

When calling for help, make sure to tell someone directly to call 9-1-1; shouting "someone call 9-1-1" will likely lead to no one calling, as everyone else thinks someone has already called for assistance.

Summary Checklist:

1. Make sure the scene is safe.
2. Check for responsiveness and breathing.
3. Call 9-1-1 and get an AED.

4. Start compressions (100–120 BPM, 2 inches deep).
5. Perform 30 compressions : 2 breaths (not required if not comfortable).
6. Use an AED and continue compressions until emergency help arrives.

Works Cited

American Red Cross. (2025). What is CPR? | Red Cross. [Www.redcross.org](https://www.redcross.org).

<https://www.redcross.org/take-a-class/cpr/performing-cpr/what-is-cpr>

American Red Cross. (2019). CPR Steps. Red Cross; American Red Cross.

<https://www.redcross.org/take-a-class/cpr/performing-cpr/cpr-steps>